

SUSHMA BOPPANA

SCHOOLING STUDENTS FOR LIFE LONG SUCCESS

Hailing from a family of passionate educators, Sushma is taking a well-structured, “formatted for success” education pattern nation wide, giving wings to the dreams of millions of students across the country.

As the CEO of Sri Chaitanya Educational Institutions founded by her parents, Dr. B. S. Rao and Dr. Jhansi Lakshmi Bai, Sushma is making them proud. Started in 1986 as Sri Chaitanya Girls Junior College, it has now emerged as one of the country's leading educational institutions with over 8,50,000 students, 900+ branches across over 250 cities in 26 states.

“If there is a student who wants to learn and do well, we want to be there to support them. It's a value we live by,” is the credo by which Sushma lives.

Right from its founding years, the institution has empowered students with an education that can change their destinies. It focused on preparing higher secondary (11th and 12th grade) students for local and state-level competitive medical and engineering exams. “We were doing very well in the state-level engineering exams”, recalls Sushma.

Sushma shares, “I have always felt that going out of state to a national university adds a lot of value, exposure and expertise to the students because of the mix of people, faculty and cultures they encounter. It's not just about the academic transition, but also the cultural transition for them to do better.”

Shifting the focus to nationwide entrance exams like that for the All India Institute of Medical Sciences and the Jawaharlal Institute Postgraduate Medical Education & Research for medical students, or the IIT or National Institute of Technology (NIT) for engineering, Sri Chaitanya recreated one integrated curriculum that covered all relevant examinations, be it the board, state or national level. “We demonstrated that the exams were not as difficult or as complex as they seemed. We ensured that every student had an opportunity to succeed if they prepared in a certain way”, Sushma comments.

It was a move that changed the thought process of the students and parents alike. She explains, “If you looked around the country, everyone was training students for a certain sector only; not for any competitive exam like us”. The new curriculum, taught by the Sri Chaitanya educators, focused on helping students understand the fundamentals and concepts rather than push them to rote learning.

Sticking to the same pursuit for perfection, Sushma who studied for her Masters in IT in the United States drew on her corporate experience to take the organization to a different league. Expanding Sri Chaitanya to cater to students from kindergarten to 10th to 12th Grade she has started inculcating knowledge learning in children, right from the beginning. She says, “We believe catching a student early will make their journey stronger and build a robust learning foundation.”

Sushma is firm in the belief that it is the school's role to develop both student and parents for exposure to competitions, the opportunities and equip them with the skill sets needed. As a step in this direction, she launched Infinity Learn – a platform that allows students who are not part of Sri Chaitanya's physical branches to join in and listen to its expert teachers, follow its curriculum and sit for its exams.



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Director, Sri Chaitanya Educational Institutions

Bolstered by the successes, Sushma is planning rapid expansions over the next three-to-five years. By 2025, she hopes an extra 300 schools will have been opened. “Our aspiration is to reach around 10,00,000 students through 1,200 schools,” she says, and is aiming for similar student figures with Infinity Learn.

Signing off she says, “I feel that if one woman does well, another 10 women and 20 students will benefit from it”. We can't agree better.

We have historically best results in the industry in 2023 as Sri Chaitanya classroom program students secured All India Rank 1 in JEE Advanced and All India Rank 1 in NEET.